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In addition to the Indian IT think tank NASSCOM, several global entities have expressed the point of view that computer networking is one of the best and “hottest” career fields available today. Many industry leaders believe there already exists a serious dearth of qualified personnel to fill the multitude of networking jobs available in the industry.

Need for networking

Operations in major industries such as banking, retail, manufacturing, biomedicine and defence is constantly changing and becoming more streamlined with the emergence of newer technologies for computer networking.

Job description

The most common job titles are Network Administrator, Network (Systems) Engineer, Network (Service) Technician, Network Programmer/Analyst, Network Architect, and Network/Information Systems Manager. A post inviting applications from networking professionals at an IT job portal reads, “Candidate will be responsible for analysis, installation and configuration of company networks. Daily activities include monitoring network performance, troubleshooting problems and maintaining network security...”

Are certifications necessary?

Along with a formal education (preferably in computer sciences), students also need to embellish their resume with some networking-based certifications. These

the individual is already employed, the employer may reimburse the cost of the certification. However, it is not as if the certification is only thing that is needed to enhance anyone’s career prospects, no one can deny the importance of a proper formal education. You also need to embellish your resume with details of actual work experience.

Training

Although a degree or diploma in computer science, electronics or telecommunications is preferred, even non-engineering personnel can enter the field; only thing is that they must possess a good knowledge of computer fundamentals. Many corporates prefer to hire individuals who have done a four-year degree course, and also have the right kind of global certification. Several coaching institutes in India train students popular certifications such as MCSE and CCNA.

Currently, CDAC (Centre for Development of Advanced Computing) Hyderabad offers a 22-week course called CNSS (Certificate course on Networking and System Security). The course is designed in such a way that working individuals can also participate. In order to be eligible for the course, you must have an Engineering Degree in Electronics / Electrical / Communications / Instrumentation / Computer Science / Information Technology. Those who have done M.Sc. Electronics / Computer Sciences or M.C.A. or Diploma / B.Sc. in Electronics / Computer Science with 2 years of experience in the relevant field are also eligible.



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Let them network...

You can be a successful computer networking professional if you have the right credentials and are prepared to work hard. The competition for high paying quality jobs is really high.

days, the certifications that are most commonly sought by different companies are Microsoft MCSE and Cisco CCNA. Others prefer Novell’s CNE or Sun Microsystems’ Sun Solaris Administrator. There are hundreds of certifications that a networking professional can go in for.

Even if you opt for the self-study route, you will have to pay the sitting fee, which can range from ₹5,000 to ₹15,000 to take an examination. In cases where

Applicants have to take an entrance test before they can enrol into the CNSS course. The total course fee is ₹45,000. Other CDAC centres around the country offer other kinds of courses in computer networking.

Popular institutions such as NIIT, Aptech and others provide a range of options. Aptech has come up with a program going by the name of N-Power, which offers latest courses in hardware and networking. The curriculum is developed